on strengthening contacts in the IT and hydrocarbons sector, particularly the energy sector as an important area for expansion of cooperation between our two countries.

The Australian Prime Minister Julia Gillard visited India on 15–17 October 2012. Three Memorandum of Understandings (MoUs) were signed pertaining to:

1. Civil Space Science, Technology and Education;
2. Field of Wool and Woolen products;
3. Student Mobility and Welfare;
4. Mining and National Skill Development Cooperation.

The second India-Japan 2 + 2 Dialogue was held in Tokyo on 22 October 2012. The Indian delegation was led by Foreign Secretary Ranjan Mathai and Defence Secretary Shashi Kant Sharma. The Japanese delegation was led by Deputy Foreign Minister Akitaka Saiki and Administrative Vice Defence Minister Hironori Kanazawa. These 2 + 2 consultations at Senior Official level are mandated by the Action Plan to Advance Security Cooperation concluded between the two countries in December 2009. These consultations were built on the last round of the 2 + 2 Dialogue held at New Delhi in June 2010. Apart from briefing each other on their respective defence and security policies in the background of each country's security environment, there was a review of bilateral security and defence cooperation and discussed ways of further expanding such ties. The two delegations also exchanged views on maritime, cyber and outer space security. They agreed to an early meeting of the new India-Japan Cyber Security Dialogue.

There was a State Visit of King of Spain to India on 26 October 2012. Five agreements/MoUs were signed during the visits pertaining to:

1. The avoidance of double taxation and the prevention of fiscal evasion with respect to taxes on income and on capital;
2. Roads and Road Transport Sector;
3. Defence Cooperation;
4. Audiovisual Co-production;
5. Technical cooperation in the field of railway sector